

Lab 4 — VibeCoding: LLM Chat History

Scenario 16 — Hangman Challenge · Tool: Claude (Anthropic) · 7 Oct 2026

Student: joelt766 (PES1UG24CS203)
Assigned repo: https://github.com/SETAPESU26/16_hangman
Submission repo: <https://github.com/joelt766/SE-PES1UG24CS203> (folder Lab-4/)

Transcript of the full conversation. Lines in italics in square brackets describe the actions the assistant ran (cloning, running the game, editing, testing, committing).

1 · Understand the code and the Task 1 bug

User: (attached Lab 4 handout PDF) heres my lab 4 handout and the repo i got assigned https://github.com/SETAPESU26/16_hangman — can u clone it and go through the readme and code first, explain how the game works and whats the bug in task 1. dont change anything yet

Claude: [cloned the repo; read README.md, main.py, game.py, words.py, stats.py, requirements.txt; ran a scripted round to reproduce the bug; left the repo unchanged]

How the game works. main.py starts HangmanGame from game.py. words.py holds three categories (technology, science, culture) with five words each and one hint per word.

- run() is the session loop: choose a category (or q), play a round, then “Another round? [y/n]”.
- play_round() picks a random word and resets the round (6 lives, no guesses, hint unused). Each turn shows the masked word, wrong letters, lives, score and streak, and accepts a letter, /hint or /quit.
- A win adds 1 to the streak and scores 5 + streak; a loss resets the streak to 0.
- /hint works once per round and costs 1 point (score floored at 0).
- Correct letters are stored in self.guessed, wrong letters in a separate set self.wrong.
- stats.py defines SessionStats, but nothing uses it yet (that is Task 2).

The Task 1 bug is in guess():

```
if letter in self.guessed:           # only checks CORRECT letters
    return "Already guessed."
if letter in self.secret:
    self.guessed.add(letter)
    return "Correct."
self.wrong.add(letter)               # wrong letters live in a different set
self.lives -= 1
return "Wrong."
```

The “already guessed” check only looks at correct letters. A repeated wrong letter passes the check and costs another life. The “Wrong:” line hides this because a set shows z once.

Reproduced with the word “python”:

Guess	Result	Lives
z	Wrong.	5
z	Wrong.	4 ← bug
z	Wrong.	3 ← bug
p	Correct.	3
p	Already guessed.	3 ✓

The fix is to check both sets before doing anything else.

2 · Show the bug, fix Task 1, test, commit

User: ok first show me the task 1 bug happening, then fix it so every letter only counts once. test it with repeated right and wrong guesses and commit just this as task 1

Claude: [ran the original game with scripted input technology, z, z, z: lives went 6 → 5 → 4 → 3 while “Wrong:” still showed one z]

The fix, one line in game.py:

```
if letter in self.guessed or letter in self.wrong:
    return "Already guessed."
```

[tested]

- Repeated wrong letter z, z, z: one life lost (6 → 5); repeats say “Already guessed.”
- Repeated correct letters p, p and y, y: counted once.
- Repeated letters later in the round are still blocked; a new wrong letter q correctly costs a life.
- Winning “python” with repeats mixed in: solved with 5 lives left.
- Six zs in a row: only one life lost.

[committed as “Task 1: each letter affects the round exactly once”]

3 · Where to push

User: did it mention that only i have to push it?

Claude: No. The handout says to push to *your repo in your personal account*, and not to raise a PR to the SETAPESU26 main repo. “Individual assignment” means don’t work with other students. I didn’t push because the only remote was the course repo, which the rules say not to push to. Deliverables go to your Lab repo under a Lab-4 folder.

4 · The prompt set for the lab

User: ok now i ned u to give me the set of prompts to ask in a row

Claude: One prompt per task, each pasted as a separate message:

1. **Understand:** explain how the game works and identify the Task 1 bug, without changing anything.
2. **Task 1:** smallest change so a letter already in guessed or wrong returns “Already guessed.” without changing lives; give a test sequence.
3. **Task 2:** integrate SessionStats: one per run, record each finished round (not /quit), start_round() resets only round state, summary printed once on every exit.
4. **Task 3:** difficulty easy/medium/hard (8/6/4 lives, x1/x2/x3 points), applied in start_round(); a hint reduces that round’s win reward consistently.
5. **Task 4:** robust input: one clear message for empty, multi-letter, digits or symbols, unknown /commands; categories and difficulty by name or number; y/yes/n/no; no duplicated feedback.
6. **Final check:** review against the README’s required-testing list; confirm no persistence or extra dependencies.

Commit after each task.

5 · Commits in the Lab repo

User: where should these commits be done

Claude: In your own copy in your personal GitHub account, never in SETAPESU26. The safest match for the handout is your Lab repo, in a Lab-4/ folder, with one commit per task.

User: can u do this to my repo with all the commits?

User: <https://github.com/joelt766/SE-PES1UG24CS203> u have to make a lab4 folder under this and do all that right?

Claude: [cloned the Lab repo and created Lab-4/]

Commit 1: original code. Unmodified starter code, committed as the baseline.

Commit 2: Task 1. The repeated-guess fix described above; retested.

Commit 3: Task 2, session statistics.

- One SessionStats per run; a new finish_round(won) updates streak and score and calls stats.record() for every completed round. A round quit with /quit isn’t counted.
- start_round() still resets only round state.
- Stats shown between rounds, and a summary (rounds, wins, best streak, final score) printed exactly once on every exit path.
- *Test:* win, win, lose, win gave 4 rounds, 3 wins, best streak 2, final score 19 (6 + 7 + 0 + 6). Quitting mid-round and q at the category prompt each print one summary.

Commit 4: Task 3, difficulty and scoring.

```
DIFFICULTIES = {"easy": (8, 1), "medium": (6, 2), "hard": (4, 3)} # lives, multiplier
# win reward = max(0, 5 + streak - (2 if hint used)) * multiplier
```

- Difficulty chosen each round after the category and applied in start_round(), so nothing leaks between rounds.
- A hint now reduces that round’s reward instead of always taking 1 point off the total.
- Points earned shown on a win; the status line shows category and difficulty.
- *Test:* hard gave 4 lives and +18; easy with a hint gave 8 lives and +5; medium with a hint after a loss gave +8; an invalid difficulty re-prompts.

Commit 5: Task 4, robust input and feedback.

- Guesses: empty, multi-letter, digits and symbols, and non a–z letters each get one message and never change state; uppercase is accepted.
- Unknown /commands say “Unknown command.”
- The board is redrawn only after a guess that changed state, so feedback isn’t duplicated.
- Category and difficulty accept a name or number; “Another round?” accepts y/yes/n/no and re-prompts otherwise.
- Ctrl+C or end of input exits cleanly with one summary.
- *Test:* a state snapshot was unchanged after `` ab 1 # é py and repeats. A full scripted session with bad input at every prompt behaved correctly. The summary printed exactly once for each way of exiting.

[final check: ran the real game end to end; only random and project modules are imported; no file storage]

Pushing from the assistant’s session was refused (GitHub app not installed on the repo), so the 5 commits were handed over as a git bundle file.

6 · Pushing from the student’s Mac

User: ok from scratch tell me what to do

Claude: Clone the Lab repo, `git pull ~/Downloads/lab4-commits.bundle main`, `git push` (with a personal access token as the password), record the before video at commit 535e51a, return to main, record the after video, then add the videos and chat PDF to Lab-4/, commit and push.

User: (screenshot: clone and bundle pull, fast-forward f32533f..b701c36) now what

Claude: The pull worked. Run `git push`, then record the videos.

User: (screenshot: GitHub asking for a username) / where tokens

Claude: Username joelt766; for the password, create a classic personal access token with the repo scope at `github.com/settings/tokens/new` and paste it.

User: (screenshot: push succeeded, f32533f..b701c36 main -> main)

Claude: All 5 commits are on GitHub. Next: the before video at 535e51a (z three times), then the after video on main (hard mode, repeated z, /hint, /hnt, /quit).

7 · Videos and chat export

User: (uploaded before.mov and after.mov)

Claude: [checked both videos] before.mov (18 s) shows lives dropping 6 → 5 → 4 → 3 for the same z. after.mov (22 s) shows hard mode, “Already guessed.” with lives unchanged, the hint, “Hint already used.”, and the session summary. Both are good.

User: not able to get the chat history

Claude: Printing the chat page from the browser only captured one blank page, so this transcript PDF was generated for the submission.

Final commit history (Lab-4/)

Commit	Message
535e51a	Lab 4: add original hangman code (SETAPESU26/16_hangman)
12bb1be	Task 1: each letter affects the round exactly once
50133b5	Task 2: integrate SessionStats across rounds
e2329c1	Task 3: difficulty levels and consistent hint scoring
b701c36	Task 4: robust input handling and single feedback per action